

rugram, property prices have skyrocketed. On Golf Course Road, where *The Camellias* and *The Dahlias* are located, per square feet prices are giving Mumbai's posh sea-facing locales a run for their money, where prices go as high as ₹1 lakh per sq. ft. Ohri says the buyers of these super luxury homes are business families, top executives, NRIs.

"The concept of a home has changed. Earlier, the glamour quotient was not that high. That has changed to a dramatic level. Home is something where they want more indulgence. Golf Course Road is the super luxury story," he says.

After entering the Mumbai market in 2025, DLF is looking to launch a Goa project in 2026. On the company's plans for Noida, which has also seen an uptick in luxury launches, Ohri says, "we will definitely do something."

There is another big trend—real estate has become geography-agnostic. "If I launch in Mumbai, buyers come from across states. Residents of Tier II and Tier III cities have also started investing in DLF properties," says Ohri. Strong participation of NRIs has also helped. "NRIs contribute 25-28% to DLF's total sales," says Ohri.

Baijal says NRIs account for about 15% of industry sales. He says the rupee's fall against the US dollar is making homes more affordable for NRIs. "Though NRIs are not always end-users, it will bring more homes in the rental market, which will ease the housing shortage".

CBRE's Magazine, however, has a different viewpoint. While the return on investment in real estate in India has been higher than in the other countries, the recent depreciation of the rupee



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AAKASH OHRI

JOINT MANAGING DIRECTOR
& CHIEF BUSINESS OFFICER,
DLF HOMES



"When you combine increase in the cost of land and the cost of construction, it's not easy to do affordable housing"

ANSHUMAN MAGAZINE

CHAIRMAN & CEO—INDIA,
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vis-à-vis dollar is a deterrent for NRIs and foreign investors, he says.

On the headwinds for the realty sector, Prestige's Shrivastava says, "On the supply side, approvals not come in time."

On the outlook for 2026, Shrivastava says as Global Capability Centres, or GCCs continue to set up shop in India, job creation will keep happening and, therefore, the influx of skilled workers or IT professionals into major markets will continue. "As long as that happens, home sales will also boom," he adds.

Falling interest rates will also keep the demand going, according to CBRE's Magazine. "This does not mean that the residential prices will keep going up. But demand on the residential side will keep the momentum going," he says.

The year 2025 has also been

good for office leasing, says Magazine. "India's GCC story is very strong. That will continue to fuel the commercial real estate market in 2026," he says.

Real estate in India is increasingly owned by institutions and not individuals. With REITs, more institution and PE money is coming into real estate than in the past. "Majority of office buildings are owned by REITs. We are seeing the same thing in retail malls, logistics warehousing, and data centres," he says.

Baijal expects real estate prices to plateau next year, something that is much needed for first-time homebuyers after a multi-year bull run has made buying a home out of reach for the most. The next chapter of the story is yet to be written. **BT**

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